Options insight

WEEKLY VOL SUMMARY

Imran Lakha | Global Options Trader

Monday, 23rd February 2026

MACRO

- SPX moved marginally higher last week as large expiries rolled off in VIX and SPX and we didn't get any escalation on the US/Iran tensions.
- Brazil outperformed again up 3.5% whilst Japan gave back some if its recent gains.
- Bonds were flat to small lower after trading firm recently despite better macro data.
- Commodities remained volatile as Oil, Silver and Uranium had the best of it.
- No asset had a weekly sigma move great than 1, showing that cross asset vol is calming down for now.
- Some positive carry returned to equities and negative GEX rolled off and 6900 provided some gravity on SPX. A move to 700 would reinforce that and likely come with a further decline in realized vol.
- Commodity carry was more mixed but some of the deep red readings in metals have reduced.
- Equity SKEW remains elevated as the market is clearly nervous and has reached for protection, particularly in NDX ahead of NVDA earnings this week.
- Oil and Silver call skew remains deep in call premium but this is justified by the spot and vol correlation being so positive. Not a fade yet.
- Brazil on the other hand is showing some signs of divergence. Spot is at the highs but vol is benign and skew is catching a bid for puts. Classic pullback setup as per our DELTA framework. Longs should be hedged or tactical shorts added based on these vol metrics.

INDICES	SPY	QQQ	DIA	IWM	EFA	INDA	FXI	EWJ	EWZ	EEM	EWW
	1.13%	1.14%	0.16%	0.63%	0.63%	1.00%	1.25%	-2.54%	3.44%	2.00%	0.25%
BONDS	IEF	TLT	LQD	HYG							
	-0.12%	-0.35%	0.00%	0.19%							
COMMODITIES	USO	XOM	GLD	SLV	FCX	URA	UNG	ADM	MOS	GDX	SIL
	6.07%	-0.79%	1.30%	9.90%	2.39%	4.72%	-3.46%	-2.34%	-0.74%	2.23%	6.01%

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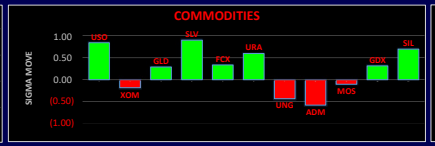

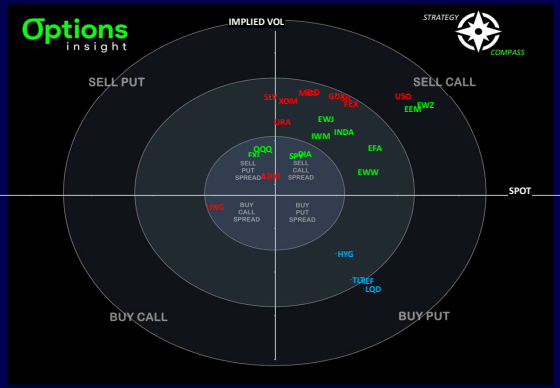

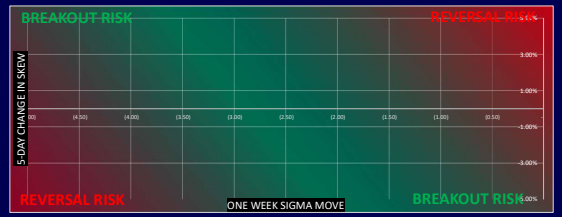

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VOLATILITY METRICS

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HISTORIC	PERFORMANCE (%)				σ MOVE		REALISED VOL		IMPLIED VOL			5	CARRY	BOLL%	IV %-ILE	SKEW	SKEW	5	DIVERGENCE?
TICKER	SPOT	1D	1W	1M	1D	1W	HV10	HV30	IV30	IV90	T/S	Δ VOL	(IV-RV)IV		30	1M 25D	PERCENTILE	Δ SKEW	
SPY	689.43	0.72%	1.13%	0.03%	0.73	0.52	13.91	12.22	15.59	15.85	0.98	(1.33)	10.76%	53.99%	68.00%	7.81%	90.30%	0.10%	✓
QQQ	608.81	0.88%	1.14%	-2.23%	0.65	0.39	17.24	16.54	21.28	21.43	0.99	(1.98)	18.96%	42.28%	71.50%	9.13%	93.80%	0.20%	✓
DIA	496.08	0.34%	0.16%	1.05%	0.38	0.08	15.05	12.84	14.38	14.75	0.98	(1.11)	-4.61%	56.87%	69.20%	6.05%	85.30%	-0.12%	✗
IWM	264.61	0.00%	0.63%	-0.08%	0.00	0.19	22.60	18.43	23.37	22.89	1.02	(0.54)	3.31%	65.19%	74.20%	7.21%	92.60%	1.15%	✓
EFA	104.90	0.81%	0.63%	4.93%	0.88	0.31	13.68	13.37	14.56	15.07	0.97	(0.64)	6.05%	79.75%	71.90%	7.78%	88.00%	3.59%	✓
INDA	53.42	2.10%	1.00%	4.25%	2.09	0.45	17.06	16.17	15.94	16.42	0.97	1.28	-7.05%	68.68%	79.20%	0.85%	12.30%	0.22%	✓
FXI	38.81	0.52%	1.25%	-1.60%	0.32	0.36	19.03	20.24	25.28	24.33	1.04	0.96	24.74%	40.49%	68.80%	1.82%	81.10%	1.03%	✓
EWJ	91.47	0.30%	-2.54%	8.17%	0.21	-0.84	26.57	20.10	21.83	22.88	0.95	(1.98)	-21.72%	63.45%	85.00%	0.03%	7.30%	0.80%	✗
EWZ	39.37	1.93%	3.44%	7.60%	1.01	0.82	23.91	26.33	30.35	30.26	1.00	(0.32)	21.23%	95.78%	91.10%	5.17%	73.40%	1.12%	✓
EEM	62.34	2.09%	2.00%	5.54%	1.59	0.69	18.50	17.03	20.86	19.86	1.05	(0.05)	11.30%	94.33%	89.20%	3.94%	80.70%	0.61%	✓
EWW	81.23	1.59%	0.25%	6.77%	1.11	0.08	23.21	24.87	22.80	21.73	1.05	(1.04)	-1.83%	76.39%	60.70%	1.32%	41.10%	-3.11%	✗
IEF	97.09	0.00%	-0.12%	1.19%	0.00	-0.19	4.54	4.31	4.73	5.19	0.91	(0.18)	4.05%	78.08%	11.10%	-0.73%	13.80%	0.33%	✗
TLT	89.41	-0.23%	-0.35%	1.68%	-0.37	-0.25	9.77	9.57	10.03	11.14	0.90	(0.67)	2.64%	74.66%	11.50%	0.02%	28.00%	0.80%	✗
LQD	111.59	-0.08%	0.00%	0.68%	-0.26	0.00	3.07	4.29	4.98	5.89	0.84	0.04	38.41%	78.90%	7.30%	0.65%	5.00%	-0.19%	✓
HYG	81.00	0.07%	0.19%	-0.17%	0.30	0.34	2.03	2.32	3.89	4.74	0.82	0.08	47.78%	69.85%	23.40%	2.81%	61.10%	-0.45%	✗
USO	80.85	-0.42%	6.07%	9.33%	-0.13	0.85	32.95	34.81	51.36	46.20	1.11	14.37	35.83%	91.87%	95.30%	-18.29%	3.00%	-10.21%	✗
XOM	147.28	-2.51%	-0.79%	9.12%	-1.32	-0.19	35.51	29.35	30.09	28.84	1.04	3.26	-18.03%	54.19%	93.40%	1.37%	18.00%	0.10%	✗
GLD	468.62	1.93%	1.30%	2.32%	0.96	0.29	38.03	49.16	32.05	29.56	1.08	4.84	-18.67%	62.03%	97.30%	-1.44%	15.00%	-1.49%	✗
SLV	76.62	7.32%	9.90%	-17.53%	1.48	0.91	102.21	136.51	78.32	77.75	1.01	14.47	-30.50%	48.41%	95.00%	-11.57%	3.00%	-10.84%	✗
FCX	64.34	2.75%	2.39%	6.51%	0.86	0.34	48.82	51.69	50.85	49.42	1.03	0.30	3.98%	74.80%	91.90%	0.97%	25.70%	-1.31%	✗
URA	54.36	0.81%	4.72%	-4.63%	0.23	0.60	49.69	61.81	56.42	54.66	1.03	0.22	11.93%	52.35%	83.40%	2.72%	84.60%	-2.66%	✗
UNG	12.01	1.75%	-3.46%	-14.03%	0.49	-0.44	50.44	125.06	56.35	55.02	1.02	(3.95)	10.48%	30.42%	45.00%	-11.82%	18.00%	-2.48%	✓
ADM	67.88	-1.44%	-2.34%	0.55%	-0.80	-0.59	22.16	26.04	28.65	28.71	1.00	(0.32)	22.65%	48.44%	58.80%	1.83%	38.00%	0.43%	✗
MOS	29.43	-2.48%	-0.74%	2.22%	-0.80	-0.11	43.80	41.89	48.92	45.44	1.08	2.51	10.47%	60.65%	96.90%	0.67%	26.90%	1.43%	✗
GDX	106.26	1.90%	2.23%	-0.71%	0.60	0.32	66.66	66.25	50.35	47.50	1.06	2.36	-32.40%	70.06%	95.70%	1.84%	78.80%	-0.63%	✗
SIL	107.75	4.20%	6.01%	-3.42%	1.09	0.71	73.88	77.13	61.37	59.93	1.02	3.79	-20.37%	73.27%	94.60%	-0.54%	43.80%	-2.23%	✗

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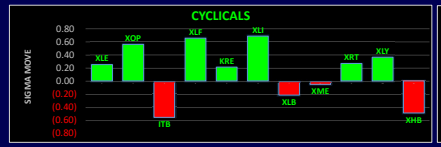
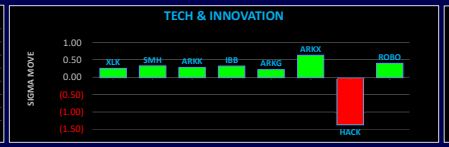
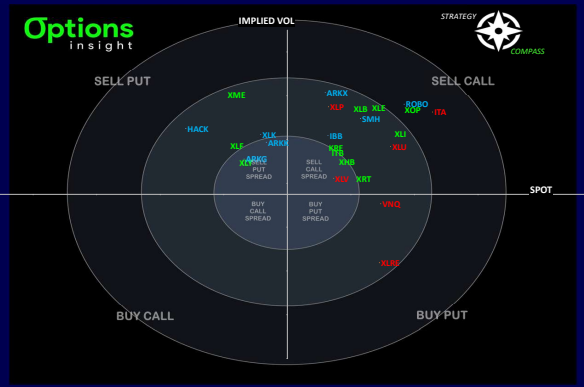
SECTORS

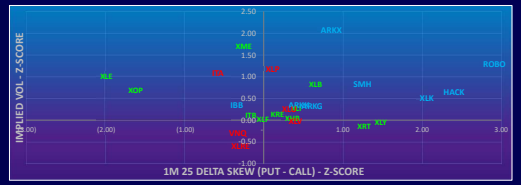
- CYCLICALS: Dominated by a surge in Energy (XOP +2.68%) and Aerospace & Defense (ITA +3.74%), fueled by heightened geopolitical angst regarding potential U.S. military intervention in Iran and stalled nuclear talks. Financials (XLF +1.63%) caught a bid as the 10-year Treasury yield climbed back toward the critical 4.10% level, boosting bank margin expectations. However, the rising yield environment directly punished the Homebuilders (ITB -2.34%, XHB -2.02%), which suffered as mortgage rates spiked and builder sentiment cooled due to persistent affordability and cost concerns.
- TECH: Investors favored hardware over software. Semiconductors (SMH +1.79%) and Robotics (ROBO +1.67%) remained resilient, but the glaring outlier was Cybersecurity (HACK -4.78%), which cratered following a shift in corporate spending priorities and news of a "triple-threat" crisis impacting global digital infrastructure. While ARKX (+3.73%) rode the tailwinds of the defense spending narrative, broader "Innovation" names like ARKK (+1.77%) only managed a partial recovery from a massive mid-February deleveraging event that had previously seen high-beta assets like Bitcoin drop nearly 20% in a week.
- DEFENSIVES: The market's primary funding source last week, with Consumer Staples (XLP -1.81%) and Utilities (XLU -0.37%) being sold off to fuel the rotation into "Risk-On" cyclicals. This "anti-defensive" move was exacerbated by the Treasury yield rally, which stripped away the relative attractiveness of high-dividend yielders like staples and healthcare.

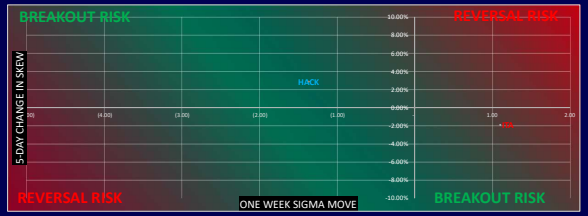
CYCLICALS	XLE	XOP	ITB	XLF	KRE	XLI	XLB	XME	XRT	XLY	XHB
	0.98%	2.68%	-2.34%	1.63%	0.87%	1.76%	-0.66%	-0.31%	0.93%	1.09%	-2.02%
TECH & INNOVATION	XLK	SMH	ARKK	IBB	ARKG	ARKX	HACK	ROBO			
	0.95%	1.79%	1.77%	1.10%	1.59%	3.73%	-4.78%	1.67%			
DEFENSIVES	XLU	XLV	XLP	VNQ	XLRE	ITA					
	-0.37%	-0.54%	-1.81%	0.31%	0.14%	3.74%					











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VOLATILITY METRICS

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HISTORIC		PERFORMANCE (%)					σ MOVE		REALISED VOL		IMPLIED VOL			5	CARRY	BOLL%	IV %-ILE	SKEW	SKEW	5	DIVERGENCE?
TICKER	SPOT	1D	1W	1M	3M	1Y	1D	1W	HV10	HV30	IV30	IV90	T/S	Δ VOL	(IV-RV)IV		30	1M 25D	PERCENTILE	Δ SKEW	
XLE	54.88	-0.55%	0.98%	11.57%	22.75%	20.67%	-0.31	0.25	22.51	22.02	27.95	26.20	1.07	3.16	19.46%	76.16%	89.60%	-7.40%	2.30%	-5.33%	✗
XOP	151.86	0.33%	2.68%	12.31%	17.05%	12.64%	0.15	0.56	32.54	29.22	34.40	32.50	1.06	3.88	5.39%	86.46%	88.40%	-0.88%	3.40%	-2.26%	✗
ITB	110.91	0.55%	-2.34%	5.44%	12.64%	13.35%	0.29	-0.56	23.48	31.12	30.15	29.07	1.04	(1.23)	22.13%	63.45%	69.20%	3.34%	30.70%	-1.47%	✓
XLF	52.49	0.65%	1.63%	-1.09%	1.59%	2.98%	0.58	0.66	19.14	16.53	17.79	17.89	0.99	(1.48)	-7.60%	35.48%	70.00%	4.12%	48.00%	-9.00%	✗
KRE	71.90	1.27%	0.87%	6.35%	16.70%	17.93%	0.69	0.21	17.56	24.22	29.24	29.22	1.00	(1.31)	39.93%	62.54%	71.50%	4.70%	58.40%	2.39%	✓
XLI	177.23	0.50%	1.76%	7.92%	18.45%	32.03%	0.43	0.69	15.77	14.39	18.33	18.71	0.98	(0.90)	13.96%	83.28%	77.60%	5.34%	71.10%	1.42%	✓
XLB	52.96	0.25%	-0.66%	5.98%	22.68%	20.42%	0.18	-0.22	18.28	19.14	21.86	21.50	1.02	(0.34)	16.38%	70.35%	88.80%	10.30%	76.10%	-4.24%	✓
XME	117.46	0.19%	-0.31%	-10.64%	32.45%	99.90%	0.07	-0.05	49.16	45.60	44.41	42.10	1.06	0.71	-10.69%	30.74%	95.70%	2.01%	36.90%	-8.54%	✓
XRT	88.66	0.72%	0.93%	-0.23%	10.91%	17.38%	0.46	0.27	21.33	19.63	25.12	25.46	0.99	(0.93)	15.09%	71.24%	56.90%	11.64%	91.10%	14.01%	✓
XLY	117.45	1.03%	1.09%	-4.61%	4.17%	7.97%	0.75	0.36	12.02	16.50	21.70	22.17	0.98	(2.00)	44.59%	37.17%	64.20%	10.16%	92.30%	11.36%	✓
XHB	118.91	0.89%	-2.02%	6.46%	14.18%	18.22%	0.48	-0.49	23.02	28.81	29.65	29.56	1.00	(0.30)	22.34%	65.75%	65.00%	5.11%	67.60%	5.56%	✗
XLK	140.88	0.48%	0.95%	-2.90%	3.13%	21.71%	0.29	0.26	26.92	24.52	26.35	25.99	1.01	(2.19)	-2.15%	41.61%	77.30%	11.56%	95.70%	2.70%	✓
SMH	415.03	1.16%	1.79%	3.73%	27.26%	70.50%	0.48	0.33	31.72	32.00	38.87	38.19	1.02	(1.37)	18.40%	73.03%	84.60%	8.28%	88.80%	-0.06%	✗
ARKK	71.49	-1.05%	1.77%	-11.41%	-2.54%	21.01%	-0.37	0.28	42.86	38.39	44.98	42.63	1.05	0.43	4.71%	43.40%	73.80%	6.69%	73.40%	-1.33%	✗
IBB	174.39	-0.37%	1.10%	-0.54%	4.10%	25.70%	-0.24	0.33	19.32	19.70	24.25	24.12	1.01	1.57	20.35%	62.80%	76.90%	2.74%	26.50%	0.05%	✓
ARKG	28.81	-3.68%	1.59%	-11.71%	-0.72%	8.76%	-1.14	0.22	40.61	44.18	51.18	50.04	1.02	2.96	20.64%	36.46%	66.10%	5.10%	73.40%	-2.88%	✗
ARKX	32.55	-1.75%	3.73%	-3.56%	25.14%	68.92%	-0.66	0.64	39.33	39.66	42.18	38.15	1.11	4.97	6.74%	61.89%	96.50%	6.91%	88.00%	3.10%	✓
HACK	74.17	-3.14%	-4.78%	-5.53%	-8.14%	-3.86%	-1.98	-1.37	32.95	26.29	25.22	25.47	0.99	(1.74)	-30.65%	18.05%	80.00%	10.34%	97.60%	2.88%	✗
ROBO	78.60	1.09%	1.67%	6.56%	22.68%	34.75%	0.58	0.40	18.40	18.51	29.85	29.35	1.02	(0.23)	38.37%	86.75%	91.10%	12.28%	97.60%	9.42%	✓
XLU	46.33	0.47%	-0.37%	8.86%	5.10%	16.00%	0.43	-0.15	18.74	15.19	17.34	17.66	0.98	(1.35)	-8.04%	82.49%	71.90%	3.65%	71.50%	2.21%	✗
XLV	156.82	-0.28%	-0.54%	-0.42%	1.43%	6.23%	-0.28	-0.24	13.10	13.25	15.94	15.97	1.00	(0.44)	17.84%	64.57%	57.30%	4.15%	69.20%	0.17%	✗
XLP	87.89	0.25%	-1.81%	6.01%	12.82%	6.62%	0.23	-0.76	14.10	14.05	17.24	16.82	1.02	(1.57)	18.23%	62.95%	90.00%	2.96%	47.60%	-3.46%	✓
VNQ	94.88	0.75%	0.31%	4.79%	5.93%	3.13%	0.76	0.14	14.71	14.07	15.64	15.61	1.00	0.42	5.93%	79.39%	45.70%	3.12%	22.30%	-1.18%	✗
XLRE	43.56	0.83%	0.14%	5.60%	6.50%	2.69%	0.89	0.07	15.36	14.89	14.75	15.54	0.95	0.34	-4.19%	78.99%	18.80%	2.93%	31.90%	-3.19%	✗
ITA	243.65	0.07%	3.74%	3.65%	22.91%	62.88%	0.04	1.11	19.33	21.73	24.38	23.85	1.02	(0.06)	20.73%	95.73%	87.60%	3.04%	20.30%	-1.91%	✗
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